CORPORATE SUSTAINABILITY OFFICERS

Pioneers of Change or Challengers of Tradition?

9 Pages | 3 min read | Easy Level

A take on Ashwath Damodaran's "The Siren Song of Sustainability"

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CSO: The Fastest-Growing C-Suite Role?

The demand for CSOs has skyrocketed in recent years, with a threefold increase in 2021 alone. But what exactly do they do?

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CSO: Prophet, Conscience, or Spin Doctor?

Damodaran identifies four broad categories of CSO roles:

1 The Visionary (Yoda)

Guiding the company towards a sustainable future.

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CSO: Prophet, Conscience, or Spin Doctor?

2 The Conscience (Jiminy Cricket)

Acting as corporate consciences, reminding the companies of the social effects of their actions.

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CSO: Prophet, Conscience, or Spin Doctor?

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3 The PR Guy

Promoting the company's sustainability initiatives, even if they lack substance.

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CSO: Prophet, Conscience, or Spin Doctor?

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4 The Preserver (Embalmer)

Focused on ensuring the company's longevity, even at the expense of sustainability.

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Sustainability Requires More Than Just Talk

CSOs need to move beyond buzzwords and superficial initiatives to drive tangible action.

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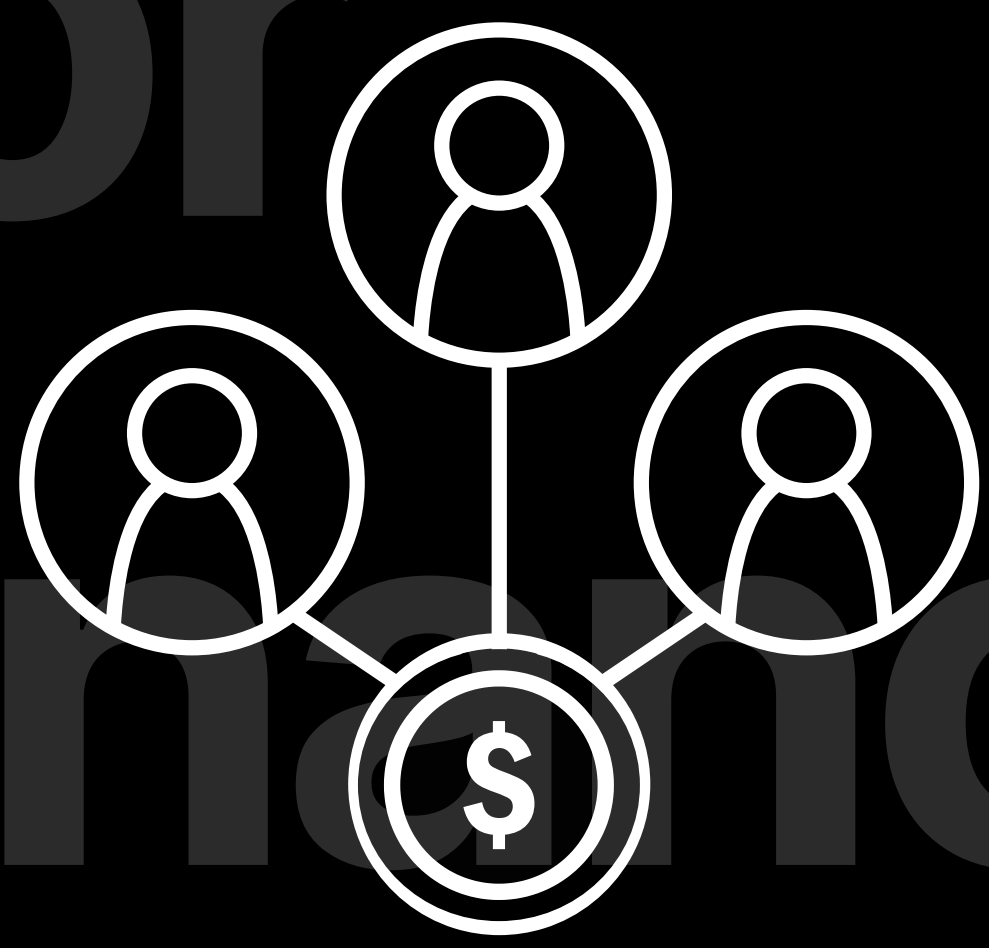
Sustainability Isn't Free: Who Pays the Price?

Acknowledging the costs of sustainability is crucial for making informed decisions. Who bears the burden of these costs?



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Rebuilding Trust: A Foundation for Sustainable Change

Sustainability initiatives need buy-in from stakeholders. This requires transparency, accountability, and a focus on tangible results.

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Are CSOs Up to the Challenge?

Can the current regulatory frameworks effectively address greenwashing?

How can these frameworks be improved to hold companies accountable for their sustainability claims and actions?

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Read.
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Rise.

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Credits: Aswath Damodaran
(Professor at NYU Stern School of Business)

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